the defining of terrorism. In a world where the community of free nations has established an international war crimes tribunal, one would think that a first priority would be to redefine the laws of war (as I discussed earlier); this would involve defining terrorism, which is the main feature of this new era of war. It seems to me that the Europeans have quite a few reasons—not necessarily professional ones—to sidestep this obstacle, but I am surprised that the American system has refrained so far from "grabbing the bull by the horns" and defining terrorism.

Another significant change that emerged from the post–Cold War geostrategic environment was the substantial upgrade in cooperation between friendly intelligence services. If in the past this cooperation was characterized mainly by the exchange of intelligence material and joint research meetings, in the new era it has been propelled to the point of operational cooperation. This step was inevitable—the countries of the world understood that in order to successfully confront global terrorism, operational cooperation between their intelligence services was essential.

Nonconventional weapons, by definition, pose a threat to global stability, and therefore all countries facing the threat, whether potentially or imminently, must cooperate in order to deal with it. Another factor that spurred cooperation was the realization by the various intelligence services, the Western ones in particular, that in the course of their activities against the threat of nonconventional weapons they were actually interfering with each other; the correct way to prevent this and to streamline their activities was through operational cooperation, which enabled coordination and the division of labor.

The most striking case of changes in the characteristics of the conflict over time is that of Iran. Iran was a country friendly to Israel since the latter's early years, and from the late 1950s it became one of Israel's most important strategic allies. This of course was until the Khomeini revolution of 1979, which turned Iran into Israel's greatest threat—a real existential threat.

It should be recalled that until the Khomeini revolution Iran was a cornerstone of Israel's national security doctrine and formed an integral part of Israel's regional alliances, with Iran and Turkey on the northern front and with Ethiopia and Sudan (and later Morocco) to the south.[1] Among other things, Iran was Israel's main oil supplier.